

Sonus Maris; Strange Attractor

Nigel Llwyd William Helyer

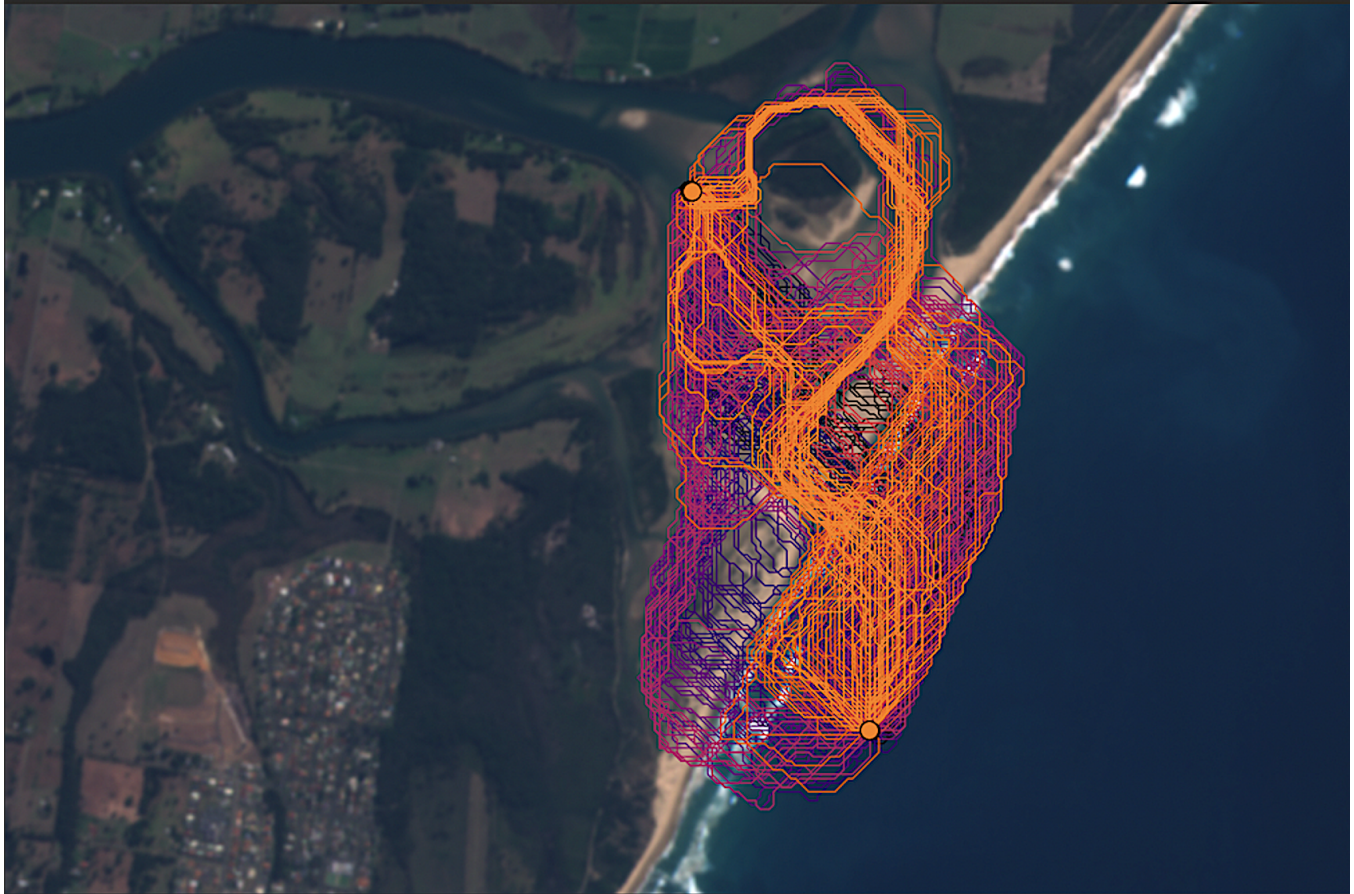
SonicObjects; SonicArchitecture

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ABSTRACT

Sonus Maris; Strange Attractor– is a two-channel video work that navigates the intersections between art and science, developed during an ongoing collaboration between artist Dr. Nigel Helyer and water engineers and scientists at the UNSW Water Research Laboratory (WRL).

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SA Art Gallery '23, December 12-15, 2023, Sydney, NSW, Australia

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ACM ISBN 979-8-4007-0308-9/23/12.

<https://doi.org/10.1145/3610537.3622944>

Working in close partnership with WRL postdoctoral researcher Dr. Tino Heimhuber, Helyer employs audio-visual media to reinterpret data charting the unique dynamics of intermittently closed and open lakes and lagoons (ICOLLs). ICOLLs are the most prominent type of estuaries found on the NSW coastline and are unique in that they alternate between open and closed oceanic entrance conditions, driven by the dynamic interplay between oceanic and land-based forces. The fluctuations of water flow act as 'canary in the mine' indicators - reacting dynamically to our increasingly kinetic weather systems.

Through data archaeology and a novel algorithm "Inlet Tracker", the collaborators extract valuable information from a fourdecade archive of public satellite imagery, drawing attention to long-term morphological and eco-hydrological variations in these crucial sites. Helyer interprets this detail-rich source material to compose a

series of musical scores translating the flow dynamics of the four ICOLLs sites as a multisensory experience. Helyer's animations of satellite imagery and experimental music invite audiences to rethink knowledge systems by seeing, feeling, and hearing the flows and patterns of coastal environments.

ACM Reference Format:

Nigel Llwyd William Helyer. 2023. Sonus Maris; Strange Attractor. In *Proceedings of SA Art Gallery '23*. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 2 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3610537.3622944>